

NATION IN RUIN, YET IS LIVING

(Continued from page 1)

many is ruling the mining industry with an iron hand, and through a central bureau sells, at prices fixed by itself, such products as it desires. The price obtained by such sale is turned over to the mine owners, less a commission to cover expenses of the managing bureau.

All quarries are lying idle, owing to the inability to obtain explosives for blasting. Reasons for the German embargo on explosives in Belgium may be readily imagined.

During the early part of 1915 there was an "economic awakening" in Belgium under the German leadership of the governor general. Many obstacles have been found in the way of the resumption of all kinds of industry, owing to relations between the conquerors and the conquered; but the productive genius of Belgium is slowly overcoming these. Some assistance has been received from a German trade commission, established by the governor general. This body has power to advise manufacturers and businessmen on how best to resume work under the present abnormal conditions, and is empowered to call on Belgian and German experts for advice. However, the work of the commission has no binding force, and its recommendations may at any time be countermanded by the governor general—who is supreme in command of all things not military.

Such is the picture of conquered Belgium presented through the report of Consul General Watts to the government at Washington. It is a picture devoid of sensational coloring, untainted by sympathy with either the Germans or the Belgians. It is a trade report, pure and simple—but it shows more plainly than many thousands of dispatches the utter ruin wrought in Belgium by the German invasion; and the brave attempt of the plucky nation to recover to some degree its normal place in the world; an effort that is hampered always by the lack of real sympathy between the conquering Germans and the conquered but undismayed Belgians.

TIME FOR GOOD ROADS IS NEAR

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of Oak Grove, and previously quoted in the Courier, have shown that such a highway can be laid at a cost little in excess of 25 cents per square yard.

Judge Anderson's stand for bituminous macadam highways, and the desire of Commissioner Mattoon to abolish the supervisor system, deserve the hearty support of every taxpayer and voter in the county, in the opinion of the Courier. Such radical reforms are badly needed, and should be put in force as soon as possible on the trunk-line highways of this section. The results will equal, to all practical purposes, those that would be obtained from a bond issue to finance hard-surfacing; and the saving to the taxpayers will be considerable.

While giving its support to Judge Anderson and Commissioner Mattoon in this matter, the Courier feels, however, that Judge Anderson's plan should at this time only extend to the trunk highways. This paper believes that good macadam roads, with an oil dressing upon completion, will still serve for the connecting highways and branch roads. Highway Engineer Hobson, who is now doing some wonderful road work in Tillamook county, has found that such roads, when properly laid, will give a satisfactory service; and is successfully constructing miles of them in the coast county.

Mr. Hobson's apparent failure to secure results in this county, it develops, were not his fault at all. When his advice was taken on road building in this section, good roads were obtained. But all too frequently Mr. Hobson's recommendations were ignored by the county court here, and roads that he had surveyed and planned were turned over to the tender mercies of well-meaning but incapable supervisors, with the result that poor roads were built—while the blame for them was passed on to Mr. Hobson.

The Courier hopes that the county court will lose no time in following the recommendation of Judge Anderson and Commissioner Mattoon, and believes that if this is done Clackamas county will redeem herself from the reputation now borne of having "the rottenest roads in the Northwest."

COUNCIL STARTS THINGS

(Continued from page 1)

Since the old rock-crusher battle the plant has been sold under foreclosure, and its present owners are said to be willing to unload it cheaply.

In the course of his argument in behalf of the purchase of "a rock-crusher, Mr. Templeton deplored the fact that Oregon City had no suitable street maintenance machinery, told of the woes of renting a steamroller from Milwaukee at a price that would pay the interest on one if purchased by the city; and generally deplored the enforced lack of economical methods in street work in the county seat. This was quite a brave speech for Mr. Templeton, as he is chairman of the street committee, and has the alleged uneconomical work in charge.

Councilman Albright added joy to the general festivity of the "thirtieth" session by taking a verbal crack at the city's public drinking fountains, pronouncing them unsanitary. He said nothing about the sanitary qualities of the river water that bubbles through them. Councilman Metzner also found fault with some of the fountains and suggested that their locations be changed, and the matter was placed in the hands of the street committee.

The Courier for job printing

THE BARD OF AVON

Now It Is Alleged That Shakespeare Was Illiterate.

COULD NOT WRITE, IT IS SAID.

An Expert In Such Things Claims That an Analysis of the Signatures Left by the Immortal William Strips Him of All Literary Credit.

The question of who did "write Shakespeare" does not concern William McConway, who has written a monograph on his Shakespeare theories, so much as "could William Shakespeare of Stratford-on-Avon write at all?" Mr. Conway is convinced that, whoever did write the plays, it was not the bard of Avon, so called. He bases his belief on evidence presented by certain existing signatures made by William Shakespeare and which seem to prove him to have been an illiterate man.

Mr. McConway admits that, though so evidently illiterate, Shakespeare possessed native ability, manifested by his money getting faculties, and adds the fact that as a theatrical manager Shakespeare secured to himself the plays that he did and thus stamped himself a competent man of business and a judge of public taste. But in regard to certain deficiencies exhibited by his signature Mr. McConway, after having made a study of the characteristics of signatures, says:

"Observations of the efforts and performances of illiterate men in the laborious production of signatures has led me to the conclusion that there was a man ashamed of his inability to write, made so by his associations and the rise in his condition of life, seeking to cover his intellectual nakedness with a garment provided by a sympathizing friend."

"The sympathizing friend in this instance floated into the imagination in the form of some scrivener who 'set the copy' so laboriously reproduced in the form of the signatures to the deed and mortgage of 1613 and to the will of 1616."

Mr. McConway refers to the original documents unearthed by Professor Wallace in 1910, and his theory is that the solicitor who drew up the papers of the mortgage and of the will is the man who made for Shakespeare a copy of his name, which the illiterate Shakespeare then followed in scrawling, under certain imitation to make the signatures to the documents. This saved him from the humiliation of having to make "his X mark."

A second document put in evidence by Mr. McConway is a fragment relating to litigation in respect to certain money interests in the Globe theater. In this fragment appears, in two places, the name "Wm. Shakespeare," written by the professional scrivener who prepared the case. Mr. McConway points out that Shakespeare's own signature appended is a laborious imitation, performed by a man who could not read his chirography when he had written it.

Mr. McConway is convinced that this scrivener is the man who made the copy which enabled "Wm. Shakespeare" to execute legal papers without the humiliation of the "X mark." The rule of legal procedure required the evidence to be written out and signed by the witness before leaving the presence of the court.

"Special attention is called to this signature," says Mr. McConway, "as it is much abbreviated. The 'great dramatist,' who had at his command, as evidenced by his putative works, a wealth of words measuring five times the number gathered into the dictionary of the time, uses but a moiety of the characters which he had been taught to use as the ideograph to represent his name."

"We are told that he was instructed to appear later before the court for a further examination, but the record nowhere shows that he ever appeared, although the other witnesses appeared a second time. Would they be considered cynical who might surmise that the position in which Shakespeare of Stratford found himself when called upon to attach his signature to the record in open court was one of extreme embarrassment in that he could not without some exposure of ignorance use his 'copy' to guide his pen?"—New York Sun.

Queen Mother. "Isn't that perfectly ridiculous?" exclaimed Mrs. Binks. "That young Mrs. Upstart who lives around the corner actually has the audacity to claim that she is of royal lineage?"

"Well," said the head of the house, stroking his gray mustache as he thought of bygone days, "she may not be so far wrong at that. I remember her mother when she was a girl, and believe me, she was some queen!"—St. Louis Post-Dispatch.

Consistent. Mrs. Exe—Here's an invitation from Mrs. Borelough to one of her tireless diners. I invite them. Exe—Why not plead a previous engagement? Mrs. Exe—That would be a lie. Edith, dear, write Mrs. Borelough that we accept with pleasure.—Boston Transcript.

Modern Life. "Formerly a girl took pride in accumulating linen for her linen chest." "Well?"

"Now she collects a lot of phonograph records."—Kansas City Journal.

Experience takes dreadfully high school wages, but he teaches like no other.—Carlyle.

"SAVING MONEY FOR TAXPAYERS."

(Continued from page 1)

will then know just how popular he is with a portion of the voters, and may be governed accordingly. And to make this test at a city election will not require any great campaign outlay.

As things now stand, this seems to be the chief merit in the plan from the viewpoint of the Courier. This paper cannot see the wisdom of providing jury trials and increasing the

fee system for the trivial cases that are the rule in the recorder's court. Nor can this paper see the great wisdom in having the city recorder elected instead of appointed. And in regard to making the city engineer's job elective, instead of appointive, the Courier sees a direct menace in the plan.

When the council picks the city engineer it is pretty apt to pick a man of honesty and sufficient experience. But if the office is thrown open to an election scramble, there is no guarantee that the candidates would be the sort of engineers that the city ought to have. They might be men who would expect to piece out their salary by accepting graft from paving companies for the acceptance of poor work—they might be men who would seek the office for the profits to be gained. Making the city engineer elective is a step in the direction of the spoils system; and it is hard to see how even Mr. Stone can have the temerity to advocate it in public.

LOST—A two-year old bay mare colt, with white spot on forehead. Information leading to her recovery will be suitably rewarded.—Redland 24—F. Catho, Oregon City, Rt. 2.

...Additional...
...Locals...

Rev. E. A. Smith, who recently met with an accident on August the eighth, will be out at Logan, Redlands and Damascus next Sunday in order named. This will be his farewell visit to those places.

You can buy a hammock at Huntley Bros. Co. for one-third less than the market price. Sale begins Friday. Regular prices \$1.00 to \$7.00. Pick yours early at one-third off.

Butter Paper at Huntley Bros. Co. 110 sheets for 20c.

If you are in Oregon City Saturday, look at those hammocks at Huntley Bros. Your choice at one-third off marked prices.

Mrs. Clara Williams, Miss Helen Ely and Miss Isabel Portow returned Monday from a week-end trip to Seaside, where they had an enjoyable time.

H. D. James, of Tacoma, is visiting with his parents, Mr. and Mrs. E. A. James, of the county seat.

Miss Arlene Haworth, of Clackamas, spent the week-end with her sister in Milwaukee.

Mr. and Mrs. Peter Smith, of Canemah, have returned from a vacation at Newport.

Carl Gray and Miss Alice Carpenter, both of Molalla, were married in the county seat during the week.

Rev. T. W. Milliken officiating. Elmer Marvin, sheriff of Wallawa county, was in the county seat early in the week.

Thomas Walker, of Milwaukie, has returned home after a lengthy visit in California.

Miss Ada Bedwell, of the county seat, has left for two weeks' vacation on the Tillamook coast.

Mrs. Brunner, of Portland, is visiting her daughter, Mrs. Erickson and Mrs. John Roppell.

Miss Ethel Davies returned Saturday from a two weeks' visit spent at Barview and Lake Lytle.

Mr. and Mrs. Fred Meyers were Portland visitors Sunday.

Mrs. Wheeler Church, who accompanied friends to Mt. Hood, returned after a visit of two weeks.

Mr. and Mrs. Frank Schoenborn, accompanied by Mr. and Mrs. Frank Schoenborn, of New York, left Sunday for Seaside, where they visited Mr. and Mrs. Nat. Smythe.

Miss Josephine Newton was a Portland visitor last week.

O. P. Edwards is confined to his home with a badly burned arm.

Mrs. Toplar, of Clarks, visited Mr. Toplar at St. Vincent's Hospital Wednesday. Mr. Toplar is suffering with blood poisoning caused by a blister on the heel.

Mr. and Mrs. David Jones and daughter, from Beaver Creek, were in Oregon City Wednesday.

Mrs. W. B. Shively and daughter accompanied by the former's son, W. B. Shively and family, went to Gresham Sunday by auto. Little Miss Elizabeth Shively returned to Oregon City for a visit with her grandmother Mrs. Shively.

Mrs. John Finneane, accompanied by Mrs. O. P. Edwards, was a Portland visitor Monday.

Mrs. I. Tolpalar is spending the summer at the beach for the benefit of her health, with her daughter, Mrs. A. A. Price.

Charles Caulfield was one of a party who ascended to the top of Mt. Hood last week. Mr. and Mrs. Caulfield and friends are camping at Mt. Hood.

Mrs. A. A. Schoenborn, Mrs. Henry Schoenborn and Miss Katie Durbin, Mr. and Mrs. Frank Schoenborn and children and Miss Elsie Schoenborn went to Wilhoit Springs Sunday by auto.

Mrs. G. Florey and little daughter were Portland visitors Tuesday.

Labrot Edwards and Mr. and Mrs. McBain and family left Sunday by steamer for a month's visit at the San Francisco fair.

Miss Eve Alldredge has returned to her home after a week's vacation at Barview.

The Presbyterian church on the hill is receiving a new coat of paint.

Mrs. Bertha Adams was a Portland visitor Tuesday.

Notice

Sealed proposals will be received by the County Court until 10 o'clock A. M. on Friday, September 3rd for the construction of a tool house; plans and specifications for which may be seen at the County Clerk's Office. The right to reject any and all bids is expressly reserved by the County Court.

H. S. ANDERSON
W. N. MATTOON
A. H. KNIGHT

LOVE LINKED WITH DEATH.

Where Women Propose and if Rejected Must Kill Themselves.

In the Pacific ocean, between Fiji, New Guinea, New Caledonia and the continent of Australia, lies the Melanesian group of islands, where head hunters and cannibals abound. Strange and gruesome are many of the customs of the tribes, there are some that are most romantic. For instance, on the island of Tucopia the women propose marriage instead of the men.

When a girl of Tucopia sees a man whom she thinks she would like to have for her husband she does not rush up to him and ask him to marry her. On the contrary, she gives the subject deep thought and often the man a most careful investigation before she "pops the question." The reason is that his answer spells life or death to her.

It is a tribal law that any woman who has been refused must forthwith kill herself. Therefore a woman asks a man's hand only when she feels sure that his answer will be the happy one.

Many are the strange and seemingly inexplicable questions with which the women of Tucopia ply the stranger who cannot realize the personal motive back of the solicitude of the dusky belles who inquire if he is married or not and the state of his wife's health. Romances are consequently very apt to turn out in happy marriage.

But there have been innumerable instances when a poor girl, smitten by the newcomer's charms, has been compelled to kill herself because the man with whom she has fallen in love has had to refuse to marry her.

Baldness with the women of Tucopia is a sign of beauty, and never until she is bald does a Tucopia woman become fully convinced that she is really lovely.

But, bald or not, she takes great care whom she asks to marry her. For the tribal law has never been known to fail. If a rejected woman does not kill herself she is executed under the most dishonorable conditions by the leaders of the tribe.—Buffalo News.

ESSENTIALS OF PITCHING.

First Comes Control, Then Knowledge of a Batter's Weakness.

"Control is the thing," say all the great pitchers, and all the great pitchers agree that a study of the batsman is next in importance. There are certain batters who can punish certain kinds of balls, while against a different style of pitching they are correspondingly weak. If a batter likes a fast ball at the waist line it becomes the duty of the wise pitcher never to give him a ball to his liking. Perhaps he is weak on a curve ball at the knee on the outside. The foxy pitcher makes a specialty of offering him that kind of delivery in abundance. In deciding what is best to pitch to the various batters a brainy catcher is of wonderful assistance.

Then, too, the pitcher must study situations. When he divines that a sacrifice is the play it is usually the best plan to keep the ball high. Such a ball is harder to meet squarely, while it is almost impossible to give it definite direction. On a low ball the pitcher must usually place it toward first or third, as is desired. For batters who have a tendency to pull away pitchers usually keep the ball on the outside, mostly depending on the curve. Seldom do batters who pull meet such balls squarely. As a rule they hit fast balls on the inside hard. The batter who hugs the plate closely and steps into the ball is bothered most by a fast ball on the inside, as it has a tendency to make him meet the ball on the handle, thereby losing most of the force he puts into the swing.

The pitcher must also take into consideration the position of his infield and must know who is covering the base on a throw, so that he may pitch to aid his infielders.—Billy Evans in St. Nicholas.

New York's First Ferry.

Cornelius Dirksen was the first official ferryman on the island of Manhattan. The mooring place on the Manhattan side was about where Water street crosses the present Peck slip. He started the system in 1637. Passengers who wanted to be rowed over blew a horn for the skipper if he happened to be absent when they arrived. From Dirksen's skill grew the ferry system of the city.

No Chance.

"Your digestive apparatus is all out of kilter," said the doctor after examining his patient. "The best advice I can give you is to discharge your cook and get a new one."

"It can't be done, Doc," answered the patient sadly. "I'm married to her."—Pittsburgh Dispatch.

She Was Ready.

Former Mistress "I would like to give you a good recommendation. Delin. but my conscience compels me to state that you never got the meals on time. I wonder how I can put that in a nice sort of way? Della—Yez might just say that Ol got the meals the same way as Ol got the pay.—Puck.

His Qualities.

"What makes you think Danber will succeed as a painter?" "He has the soul of an artist and the perseverance of a book agent."—Philadelphia Ledger.

Woman's Tact.

Rev. Mr. Gaslington—Honestly, Miss Deering, do you think my sermons are too long? Miss Deering—Oh, dear, no! I merely think that life is too short.—Puck.

Mother Wins Child.

Clarence St. Clair, six years old, was this week removed from the custody of his father, Clyde St. Clair, and returned to his mother, Mrs. Emma St. Clair, upon an order of the Wallawa county courts. Sheriff Marvin, of Enterprise, came after the lad, who has been living with his father since the St. Clairs were divorced a year and a half ago. Mrs. St. Clair charges that the child's father has treated it cruelly, at one time leaving it locked in a closet while he was out of the house.

TO KILL MUSTARD

Agricultural College Gives Advice on Controlling Pest

Where fields are infested with wild mustard the land should be worked up with a disc or spring tooth harrow after the grain is harvested to cover the seeds and induce germination. The plants resulting may be destroyed by fall plowing or by freezing, preferably by fall plowing in this region. The fields should be cultivated reasonably early in the spring and before the crop is sown, if grain is raised, to kill any plants that may have started. If the cultivation can be kept up until late in the spring many of the young plants will be destroyed. A liberal seeding of grain should be made when the soil is well prepared so that the growth may be quickly made and will fully cover the ground. If the mustard starts in the grain many of the young plants may be destroyed by the harrowing with a light spike-tooth harrow. If scattering plants appear they could be pulled by hand. If in spite of the careful preparation of the land, the field should still be badly infested with mustard, the plants may be destroyed without injury to the grain by spraying.

WHAT THEY CALL 'EM

Yellowstone Park Employees Have Language of Their Own

When the Yellowstone hotel and camp men shipped their season's "help" to the park early in June to be ready for the rush of visitors, the special train that carried them afforded plenty of fun for the cities at which it stopped en route. It was a merry crowd that filled the fifteen Pullmans, one that knew how to entertain itself exceedingly well. "The employees have their own lexicon of descriptions," says the Salt Lake City News, describing the scene at the station. "The terms used to designate different classes of help are as follows: Savages—all of the help in a generic sense; Heavers—dining-room help; Wranglers—horse herders; Barn dogs—help used about the corals; Swaddies—soldiers in the park; Dudes—all tourists; Mulligan Dump—where the drivers eat. The athletic designation of Biscuit Shooters is applied to the hotel waiters."

The regular hotel help is strictly professional, but the camp help largely amateur. The Wylie Camping Co. alone received 5,000 applications for 350 places, many of the applicants being school teachers, college students and high school pupils of both sexes.

NEWS FROM MOLALLA

Telephone Service is Fine, But There Are Some Woes

We are fortunate in having one of the best co-operative telephone systems in the state. We doubt if there is another which gives anything like the same service for the same money. However it can and will be improved. Its efficiency will be increased to keep pace with the progress made by country and city. The patrons by taking thought can do much to add to the value of the line.

There is one very annoying practice which has developed on most country lines, that is of "rubbering" when others are talking. This practice is an infringement of the rights of others and is as unethical as to open another's mail and their letters. It also lowers the efficiency of the service. It is very annoying when holding a serious conversation to hear the click of receivers being taken down by eavesdroppers. Some times so many do this that conversation is impossible. In many places this offense is punished by the offenders having their phones removed. It is largely thoughtlessness which leads the "rubbernecks" to do this. If people would cease this pernicious practice our telephone service would be greatly improved.—(Molalla Pioneer.)

PARKPLACE

A Coffey returned from Walla Walla last Friday, where he has been doing farm work for the last three months. He expects to work for Ed Barnett the rest of the season.

Mrs. E. M. Blood, who has been visiting her mother, Mrs. P. M. Brayton, for the last six weeks, left for her home Tuesday morning.

Miss Eva Wallace returned to her home in Lebanon last week after making her sister, Mrs. George Washburn, a few days' visit.

Mr. and Mrs. Fred Valet and daughter left Saturday morning for the coast, where they will spend a few weeks.

Mr. and Mrs. Theodore Brown have returned to their home from Amity, where they have been visiting relatives since the first of July.

A. Davis has sold his grocery store to F. Goldson. Mr. and Mrs. Davis have left for California.

Mr. Logan, who built a fine store and had it well stocked with groceries, has sold his entire stock to John McCormick.

Potato Beetle Reappears

That the Colorado Potato Beetle has succeeded in getting established in Oregon, is the essence of reports on the situation made by Agricultural College Extension officers to the department of Entomology. The pest was first recorded in Oregon last year," said Professor Wilson, head of the department, "when it was observed in fields of Eastern Oregon. An attempt was made to stamp it out but it could not be established but its reappearance this year shows that the efforts did not entirely succeed. The beetle is readily controlled by standard arsenical sprays, and if growers will cooperate with their agricultural agents or other officials its field can be limited and the pest itself eradicated. Uncontrolled it is an exceedingly destructive pest."

Courier and the Western Stock Journal \$1.50 per year.

A BOMB AT SEA

By F. A. MITCHEL

"There's something going on aboard this ship," said one passenger to another. "We are in some danger."

"Submarines?"

"I hope not," said the other, turning pale.

"It's not submarine danger," a third put in; "it's a bomb. A wireless has been received from New York stating that a letter has fallen into the hands of the police indicating that a box is aboard containing an explosive, set to be fired in three or four days after sailing."

"Oh, my goodness gracious!" exclaimed an elderly lady sitting in a steamer chair with a very pretty daughter beside her. The mother showed signs of fainting. The daughter was very much troubled. Her mother's heart was weak.

"There's no danger, mamma; indeed there isn't. I assure you."

"How do you know? You don't know. Isn't it awful?"

"I do know." It appeared that the girl was trying to keep her mother from another danger than a bomb; therefore no one who overheard what she said paid any attention to her claiming to know that nothing was to be feared from an explosion. In the wireless message received a description of the box was given. It was six feet square and marked: "Fragile. Handle With Care. This Side Up."

A thorough search was made of the hold where freight had been stored, but it was not necessary to remove anything, for the box was found as described with nothing stored in it. An officer conducting the search listened for a ticking, but heard nothing. He was not surprised at this, for the bomb was probably in the center of the box with packing material around it.

The next information the lady and her daughter received concerning the danger was seeing the box being swung over the side of the ship. The girl gave a shriek and, running to the rail, called out frantically to those below not to drop the box into the water. The mate directed them to hold it, and while the infernal machine dangled in the air the girl ran down the companionway to a lower deck where the work of getting rid of the danger was going on. The mate, the men at the tackle and a group of passengers standing around looked at her wonderingly.

"Oh, heavens," she cried, "don't let it go; take it in!"

"What have you got to do with it?" asked the mate.

"Bring it in!"

"It's safe enough where it is. Come, confess. Are you mixed up in the plot?"

"No—yes. It isn't a plot to blow up the ship; there's no bomb in the box."

"Well, what is in the box?"

"Why, there's nothing to hurt anybody."

"How do you know?"

"Because I do."

"No such woman's reason as that can be taken where the lives of hundreds of persons are at stake. Let her go, men."

The girl sprang to the ropes. The officer made a sign for them to hold. "Come, out with it! We can't take any further risk."

"Bring it back and I'll open it if you are afraid to. There's nothing in it to hurt any one."

The box was brought back, and for the first time holes were noticed bored in its sides.

"A stowaway," remarked the man who made the discovery.

"Bring a hammer," said the mate.

The lid was taken off the box by one of the men, and the top of a man's head appeared.

"Come out o' that!" roared the mate.

The man was helped out of the box, as pale as the girl. They staggered together and fell into each other's arms. The act caused more commotion than the receipt of the wireless telegram.

"What in thunder does this mean?" asked the mate. "Young fellow, if you've been trying to bent your way you'll go down into the furnace room to shovel coal."

"Nonsense," exclaimed a passenger. "Don't you see that they're a pair of lovers?"

"A love story!" cried another looker-on. "Let's have it!"

The young man and the girl looked at each other sheepishly; then the former said:

"My friends, I suppose we'll have to confess. This young lady and I are lovers. Her mother is taking her abroad for a bit of me. It occurred to us to outwit her by my being shipped as freight. Some friends helped me. I was put in this box, with plenty of